



# **Interview With Rakib Shahriar Rimen**

**Co-founder & CEO at Booked For You**

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# BOOKED FOR YOU

REALLY GREAT SITE

## EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW

*Event Organizing  
should not be Hard  
- THAT'S what  
Booked For You  
Said*

**STARTUP  
JOURNEY FROM  
RAKIB SHAHRIAR  
RIMEN**

**13 November 2024**

# ENTREPRENEUR



[www.bookedforyou.com](http://www.bookedforyou.com)

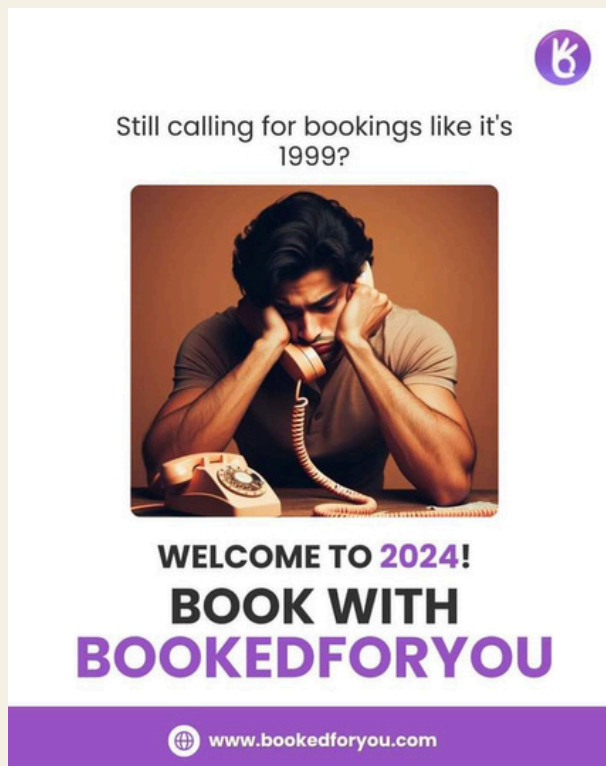
## From Problem to Execution: The Story Behind building Booked For You

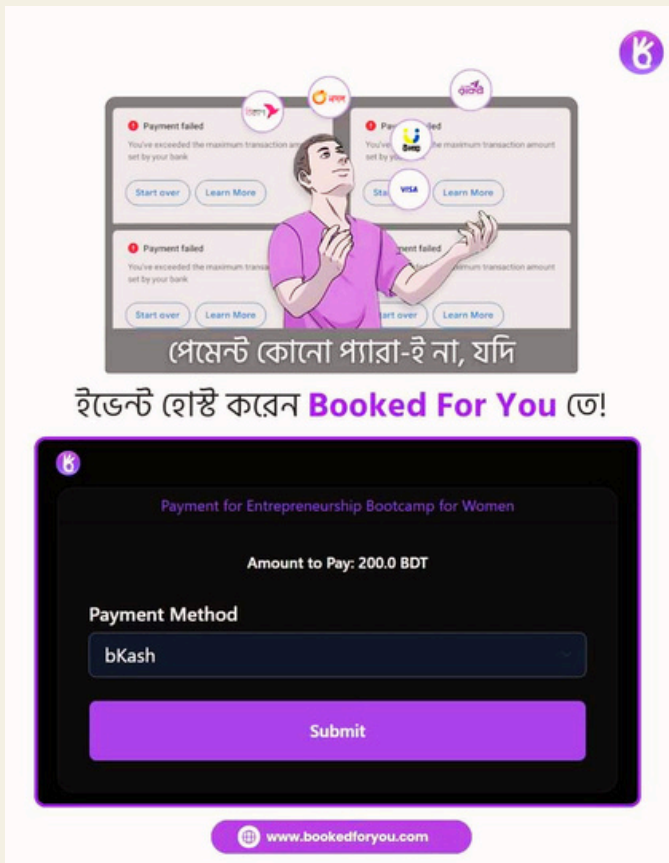
**Booked For You** started their journey in 2024 as a solution to two main challenges that Ayman and Rimen saw in the events and services space. They noticed that people were constantly juggling between websites, social media, and word-of-mouth to discover what's happening around them. Meanwhile, event organizers were facing logistical struggles with booking, ticketing, and attendance management, which took their focus away from creating impactful events.



To bring this vision to life, they enlisted Iftekhar Uccash Ahmed, a management student from BUP and a Python expert by passion, who started building the technology. As they grew, Mathew Ankon Baroi and Md. Iftakher Alam from East West University joined to strengthen their tech foundation, while Nafisa Binte Jashim came on board as their front-end designer, giving their platform a seamless user experience. Recognizing that they also needed strong outreach and planning, Anika Nawar Nishupta took charge of communication and design, playing to her strengths in this area.

Over time, they built a team that brought together talent from various universities: Saima Islam Jasita from Jahangir Nagar University and Ahammad Afif Anid from Dhaka University manage their partnerships, while Md. Deehanur Rahman from BUP handles design, and Saad Ahmad Shasso from KUET and Md. Saklain Bin Salim from BUP take charge of strategy and planning. They are also developing a network of campus partners across universities, empowering students to connect their campuses with the events and services offered on Booked For You. It's been incredible to see each team member and partner contribute to making Booked For You the go-to platform for event-goers and organizers across Bangladesh.





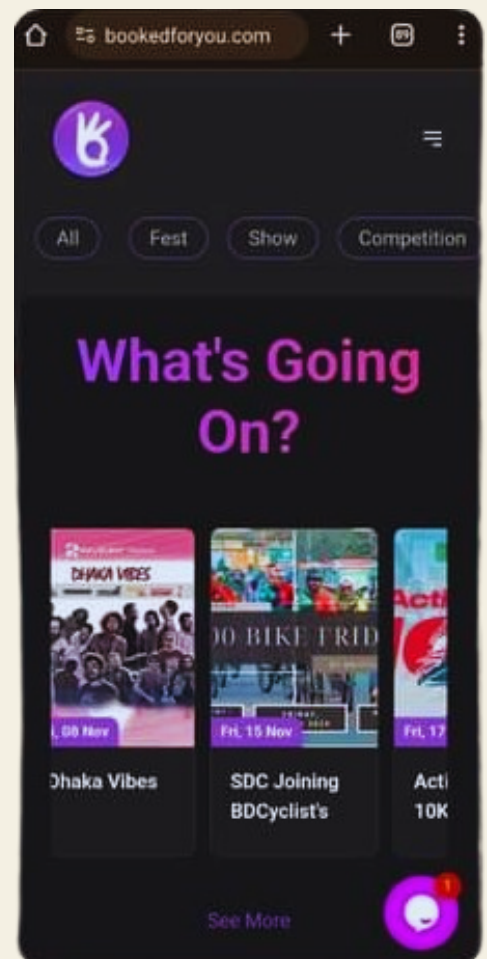
## 1. HOW DID THE IDEA FOR YOUR BUSINESS COME ABOUT?

**Mr. Rimen:** Booked For You started as a solution to two main challenges that Ayman and I saw in the events and services space. That's why we built a team who had the same struggle and vision of building a one-stop around the platform & we called it Booked For You - where people can check what's happening around them. Our main aim is “Book Great Experiences” & our main motive is to change our country's manual booking process to digital for all sectors.

## 2. WHAT THREE PIECES OF ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE TO STUDENTS LIKE OUR AGES WHO WANT TO BECOME ENTREPRENEURS?

**MR. Rimen:**

- From my perspective, I would say start, fail, and learn fast. It will enhance your risk-taking ability and reduce dependency on others as you and I are currently having an amazing time in our lives.
- Secondly, don't take everyone's advice, you may suffer in an analysis paralysis situation. Rather I would suggest you learn from the market & customer.
- Lastly, I would say don't make a solution and try to fit in a problem. Rather you should start by solving a problem that solves many entrepreneurial hassle.



### 3. IF YOU HAD THE CHANCE TO START YOUR CAREER OVER AGAIN, WHAT WOULD YOU DO DIFFERENTLY?

**Mr. Rimen:** At the end of the day, it's very important how quickly we can adapt if we fail at something or learn something. When I had to react quickly, I had to adapt quickly or I had to come up with new products and services, I was too slow to adopt them as I was less risk taker at that moment. Also, I should be more cautious about selecting Co-founder & human resources. So, I would definitely change my mindset and correct my shortcomings if I had a chance to start my career again.

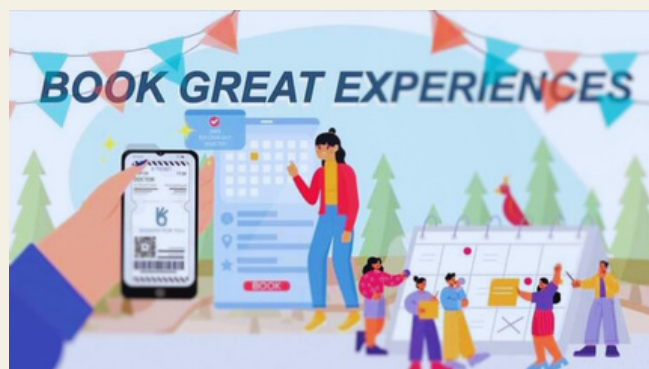
### 4. HOW DO YOU FIND PEOPLE TO BRING INTO YOUR ORGANIZATION WHO TRULY CARE ABOUT IT THE WAY YOU DO?

**Mr. Rimen:** At the end of the day, it is foolish to want to install such quality that is not within him and it's normal. Since it's your business and product, he can't be expected to put in the same effort as you. Rather if I put him on a probationary period, observe him, and then try to come to a commitment with him, it is mutually beneficial for both parties. Always remember, people always show their real faces in your odd times. So, always be careful about that.

### 5. WHAT HAVE BEEN SOME OF YOUR FAILURES, AND WHAT HAVE YOU LEARNED FROM THEM?

**Mr. Rimen:**

- You should never think of making a hypothetical product at home without going to the market. Unless going to the market & talking with your customer, you can never make a successful product. As a Founder, you have to build your products & talk with your users.
- Instead of making Startup things easier for our country, we are continuously making this over-complicated. If we look at the biggest startup Founder & school, we will see they are very simple in their language rather than us. So we have to eliminate this culture from our country.
- Another lesson I have learned is that failing is important, learning from that failing is more important & adapting to that failure, and giving a comeback from that failure is most important.



## 6. HOW IMPORTANT HAVE GOOD EMPLOYEES BEEN TO YOUR SUCCESS?

**Mr. Rimen:** Absolutely, I am able to speak to you today on behalf of my team Booked For You. I am nothing without them and I couldn't do anything without them. Every successful idea is implemented with the help of a good team. From my perspective, a team is something that makes a difference. Team helps to hold mental sanity in a startup. Also, a strong team plays an important role in instilling fear in your opponents' minds which helps you to get a competitive advantage in the market.

## 7. WHAT MOTIVATES YOU?

**Mr. Rimen:** If I am talking about this on micro level, my creator has given me a chance to do something different, he is keeping me alive everyday & he is giving me chance in every moment. On the other hand, if I am talking about this on macro level, my whole life is a chance. That's how my life motivates me.

## 8. HOW DO YOU GENERATE NEW IDEAS?

**Mr. Rimen:** I look around myself to find out what are the problem that still not sort. Then I am trying to solve them. I don't generate ideas.

I just look at the problems as an observer & try to fill it a solution for it and that's my philosophy.

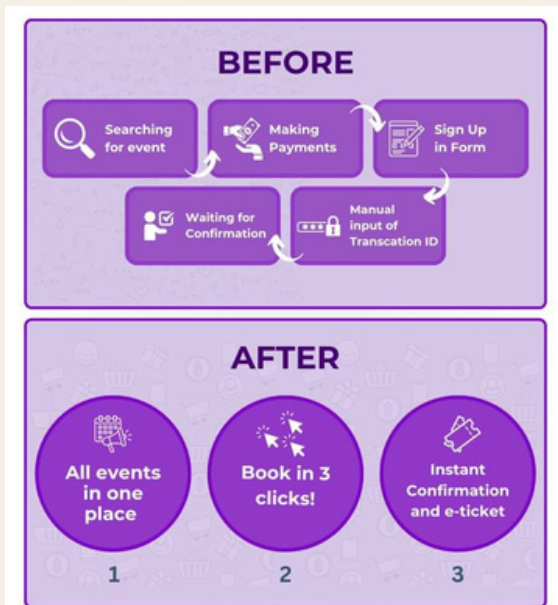


## 9. WHAT IS YOUR GREATEST FEAR, AND HOW DO YOU MANAGE FEAR?

**Mr. Rimen:** Well, my biggest fear is I create a product that isn't useful. To manage that fear, I try to talk to my users, my potential stakeholders and investors, and team members.

## 10. HOW DO YOU DEFINE SUCCESS?

**Mr. Rimen:** From my perspective, I think if I can sleep well at night by doing the things I am doing well, that's the definition of success from me.



## 11. WHAT SACRIFICES HAVE YOU HAD TO MAKE TO BE A SUCCESSFUL ENTREPRENEUR?

**Mr. Rimen:** After becoming an entrepreneur I had to sacrifice 3 things –

- Social Life
- Family Life
- Sleep
- Health

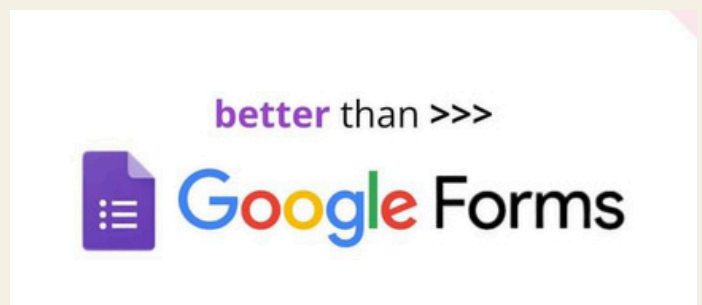
## 12. HOW DO YOU GO ABOUT MARKETING YOUR BUSINESS? WHAT HAS BEEN YOUR MOST SUCCESSFUL FORM OF MARKETING?

**Mr. Rimen:** I think you should do your marketing your product in such a way that does not feel like marketing. The best marketing I have done in my life as far as I remember that is when I went to people and I talk about my product and they said this is something that I really need.

## 13. WHERE DID YOUR ORGANIZATION'S FUNDING/CAPITAL COME FROM AND HOW DID YOU GO ABOUT GETTING IT?

**Mr. Rimen:** Right now, I run my business from my own capital. Though I bring investment in two ways -

1. I reach out to people bhai this is something that you are looking forward to.
2. People reach out to me and ask me if their any investment opportunity in my company.



## 14. WHAT ARE SOME OF THE BIGGEST MISTAKES YOU'VE MADE, AND HOW CAN YOU PREVENT SIMILAR MISTAKES OR DO DAMAGE CONTROL?

**Mr. Rimen:** As I mentioned before, there were times when I had to react swiftly, adapt, or develop new products and services, but I found myself hesitant and slow to embrace these changes due to a lower tolerance for risk. Looking back, I realize I should also have been more discerning in selecting co-founders and human resources. So from next time, I will be more cautious about the ability to adapt quickly whether after a failure or while learning something new.

**LEARNINGS FROM THIS ENTREPRENEURIAL JOURNEY**

- Adapt quickly to changes and learn from failures.
- Build a team with a shared vision and dedication to the mission.
- Solve real market problems instead of creating hypothetical solutions.
- Avoid "analysis paralysis"; focus on market and customer insights.
- A strong team brings stability and competitive advantage.
- Test and validate ideas by engaging directly with potential users.
- Be cautious and selective when choosing co-founders and key human resources.